# Fred Hollows

Although he was originally a New Zealander, Fred Hollows is one of Australia's most famous scientists – he was even named Australian of the Year in 1990.

In the 1960s Hollows helped to set up the first Aboriginal Medical Service. By 2005, there were more than 60 of them around Australia. As an eye specialist he was horrified to learn that many Indigenous Australians were blind from **trachoma** – a preventable and treatable eye disease. Hollows did many trachoma repair operations himself and started up the National Trachoma and Eye Health Program to inform Australians, to raise funds and to carry out operations.

Hollows didn't stop there. He and his teams visited many poor countries to carry out operations; they even set up a lens factory in desperately poor Eritrea. When he became terminally sick with cancer he set up the Fred Hollows Foundation, an organisation that works to prevent avoidable blindness and to improve Indigenous Australians' health. Since 1992 the Foundation has worked in more than 30 countries in Asia, Africa, Australia and the Pacific. The one millionth intraocular lens (a device used to treat cataracts, which cause blindness) was inserted in 2003.

Fred Hollows helped millions of people, and his legacy continues to help millions more.

☞ **1** Circle the correct word in each pair.

Fred Hollows treated [eye/leg] diseases. He argued [strongly/weakly] for teams to work with him to treat trachoma and other eye [diseases/glasses]. He [raised/wasted] money from people, governments and companies to [support/delay] his efforts. Many [nasty/harmless] eye diseases happen in places where people are very [poor/wealthy]. Hollows and his teams went to these places to help hundreds of thousands of people. He was a great Australian and a great [New Zealander/Canadian].

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